

On the same window (the settings window) you have options to add or remove other hardware, set the shared folders, network interfaces and so on. Explore your options and make the changes you want to and confirm the settings by clicking the “OK” button. Also remember that this is the same window you’re going to come back to if you need to change settings later on. Although we want to, this space isn’t enough to tell you about all the options that VirtualBox has in store for you. Just go, explore them all!

Your new virtual machine should be created now. Select it from the list presented to you and press the “Start” button to start installing the OS.

## Features

The feature-set of VirtualBox is not too great when compared to VMware Workstation, nonetheless it’s an impressive one and a general user as such would find it useful.

- ▶ **Virtual Machines in their own windows:** Unlike VMware Workstation which would run all the virtual machines inside its main application window as separate “tabs”, VirtualBox will open a new window for each virtual machine as and when you start them. This makes sure that your guest OS has much more screen space and you’re able to get the most benefit out of the larger screen, thus elevating your experience with the virtual machine.
- ▶ **Guest Additions:** This is the name VirtualBox uses for its guest additions. Once installed, you’ll get a better graphics performance and auto-resize capability on the guest OS along with the ability to mount your shared folders as network drives. It will also improve your network response times (so you could experience a faster network experience inside the guest OS). Also, you’ll be able to avail hardware acceleration and bi-directional clipboard. In some conditions (depending on the guest OS), it also brings in the capability of audio playback to your guest OS, which might otherwise be missing (when the guest OS is not able to detect and make use of the emulated audio device).
- ▶ **Auto Resize:** This feature is same as that in VMware Workstation and allows the display inside the virtual machine to be dynamically changed. Since VirtualBox uses separate windows for each virtual machine that you’re running, it simply means that you can use maximum of your screen space without having to switch to full screen.
- ▶ **Execution cap on processor:** Not only does VirtualBox allow you to set the number of processors that the guest operating system can use,